

BIOGRAPHY
OF
WILLIAM WILSON LUNT

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William Wilson Lunt was born July 18, 1867, at Cedar City, Utah, a son of Henry and Mary Ann Wilson Lunt, who were English emigrants and converts of the L.D.S. church. He was the fifth child in a family of eight. His father was one of the first settlers of Iron county, and was Bishop of the Cedar City Ward for many years. Henry Lunt, his father, was also a patriarch. Will's father, along with his wives Ellen Whitticar and Mary Ann Wilson, operated a hotel, telegraph office and stage stop in Cedar City for many years. At this time the famous Silver Reef mines were operating close by Leeds, Utah. Coaches carrying important people back and forth from Silver Reef stopped at the hotel. The stage drivers carrying the United States mail exchanged teams there. The teams were taken care of by Will and his older brothers, while his sisters helped his mother with the cleaning and cooking for the many important guests. Many of the general authorities of the church also stayed at the Lunt Hotel, for it was at this time the only hotel operating in this area.

Will was of a very cheerful disposition. Many times he was the "life of the family" and his associates. He loved music. He and his sister, Florence, took organ lessons from Brother Schoppmann. Will would have his sister play the lessons first; he listened, and played the music by ear. He was a member of Cedar City's first brass band, and for years "corded" on the piano while his brother Randle played the fiddle for dances. He also entertained family and friends by cording and singing hymns. At the age of 12, he joined the choir, and continued singing in ward choirs throughout his life. He was always a faithful member of the church, holding priesthood offices from a Deacon to the office of High Priest.

In 1870, a cooperation was formed by a group of men to establish a cattle ranch. It was located at Johnson's Springs near Enoch, a few miles north of Cedar City. Ranch houses were built and different families from Cedar took their turns living there, caring for the cattle, milk cows, and making cheese and butter. Sarah Lunt (a younger wife of Henry's) and two small children lived on the ranch a great deal. Will, at about 8 or 10 years of age lived there with her. His main job was to care for the cows and wrangling calves at calving time. One time he could not

find a new born calf although he had hunted diligently through the underbrush for sometime. Before going home to report the calf missing, he got down from his horse, knelt in prayer and immediately found the calf. Throughout his life, he was a prayerful, humble man. His mother, together with Ann Gower Lunt (another wife of Henry's) took their families and had their turn at ranch life. In 1884, the ranches were leased to the Clark Brothers of Parowan.

When a young man, he and his brothers were in the mountains cutting timber for a log house, and he had the misfortune of making a gash in his leg with a sharp ax. He suffered for some time, but with the care of the local doctor, George Wood, and good home nursing by his mother, with her home remedies, he escaped serious results.

Will's father, being Bishop, traveled to Salt Lake City to the General Conferences; mostly in the fall. Will made many trips there with his father, acting as his teamster. The trips usually took about three weeks. They only traveled about 30 miles a day, camping out at night, or if they were in a settlement, staying with friends.

When Will was a young man about 18, the Denver and Rio Grande railroad surveyed through southern Utah, hoping to build a railroad. The company hired him and a number of other Cedar people to help with the surveying. During the winter, which was extremely cold, he had his face frozen. After a year's time the surveying project was abandoned. However, Will worked at surveying at different periods during his married life. After the railroad project was abandoned, Will was employed as a carpenter and cabinet maker by Thomas Jed Jones, the husband of his sister Eva.

As a boy, he attended the grade schools in Cedar City and in 1889 the Parowan Stake Academy was established in Cedar under the direction of Carl G. Maeser. This school drew students from many neighboring towns, and it was here that Will met Rosanna Naegle, a girl from New Harmony. They became acquainted in October. Will made frequent trips to New Harmony by horse and buggy or horse during their courtship. The young couple often took excursions into the mountains for picnics and fishing trips. It was after a trip to Panguitch lake with his sister Florence and husband and others that Will proposed to Rose. Their marriage was solemnized Dec. 15, 1891 in the St. George Temple with Pres. J. D. T. McAllister officiating. The mothers of the couple accompanied them to the temple as well as David H. Cannon, a lifetime

friend of the Naegle family. Their fathers were unable to attend as they were in Old Mexico at the time. After the marriage, they spent their wedding night in Toquerville with Rosanna's Aunt Regulla. Returning to New Harmony, they were guests at a dinner and dance for over 100 people. A dance was also held in Cedar City in their honor.

They established their first home on first East (present location of the Fire Dept.-Harding Ave.) in Cedar City. Their first child, John Henry, was born there on Oct. 26, 1892. On Dec. 9, 1894, another son, Wilson Naegle, was born. In the spring of 1896 Will was called to the California mission. He sold part of the farm he owned to help pay his expenses. Rosanna stayed in Cedar with her boys for a year, then shortly before Will's release she left the boys in Toquerville with her mother and went out to California to spend some time with Will. On their way home they spent a week at Logan doing temple work. When they returned to Cedar City, Will resumed his work as a carpenter and farmed. He was put in as President of the M.I.A. and also served as superintendent of the Sunday School. Another son, Lanell Naegle, was born on Nov. 9, 1900. In 1901, Will purchased a farm west of Cedar and built a nice home there. On April 4, 1903, a daughter, Elva, was born. The family moved back into town about 1905 because a water system was put in town. Their home was close to the Branch Normal School (2nd West College Ave.), which had been established in 1898 while Will was on his mission, to take the place of the academy. Will continued his farming and also worked at the BNS as custodian and caretaker. On June 29, 1905, a daughter, Rozella, was born. At this time homesteading was being practiced and Will took up a ranch about 12 miles up the Cedar Canyon at "Moots Hollow." In the spring he would plant a garden at the ranch and then move his family there for the summer. Friends and their families would come spend time and the children enjoyed many wonderful times there. They took fishing trips to Navajo Lake, Panguich Lake, Deep Creek, and other points of interest on the mountains. Will loved to sing, and if the children became tired on their trip, he would start them to singing. As they neared home, "The end of a perfect day" was always sung, and has remained as a family favorite song throughout the years.

In 1910 or 1911, Will and his family moved back to the farm west of Cedar. He modernized the home, putting in the electricity and a water system. A daughter, Leona, was born Jan. 19, 1915. Early that same spring Will had ruptured appendixitis. He was taken by team to Lund,

Utah, then by train to the L.D.S. Hospital in Salt Lake City. He stayed there about 6 weeks. The operation was of a very serious nature and the recovery slow due to phlebitis setting in. His son John picked him up and carried him into the house on his return from Salt Lake. Will never did fully recover his health from this time on. Another son, Max Naegle, was born on Jan 28, 1917. A few months after Max was born, John was drafted into the armed services. When he got to Fort Lewis, Wash., he was discharged due to an injured collar bone, broken at age 7. Wilson married Agatha Day in the Salt Lake Temple, went on a mission to the Central states, and also went to the University at Logan a short while.

In May 1921, Will's physical condition was such that the doctors advised a move to Salt Lake City so he could receive further medical care. He found employment as farm superintendent at the Utah State Prison. Elva, Rozella, Leona, and Max accompanied their parents to Salt Lake. John had married Alice Bullock Schoppman, and he and Lanell remained in Cedar City to care for the farm. John died July 24, 1921, from injuries received on Cedar Mountain. After the funeral, Rosanna stayed 2 months in Cedar with Lanell to help dispose of the farm. Will and the younger children again returned to Salt Lake. Lanell was called to serve on a mission to Switzerland and Germany.

After 4 years on the farm, Will found other employment and the family moved to 2246 South 9th East. He worked at the University of Utah as a part-time caretaker, his health not permitting a full-time job. While living here, he was seriously ill with pneumonia. Elva finished high school and graduated from 2 years at the University, becoming a teacher. Rozella also graduated from L.D.S. high school. After his return from his mission, Lanell married Lucy Mitchell on Feb. 8, 1928 in the Salt Lake Temple. During the years the family lived on University Street, Will's condition became worse, requiring his going back east to receive treatment for cancer. He also underwent several operations in Salt Lake hoping to rid himself of this awful disease.

In the spring of 1929, Will moved his family to a little fruit farm in Holliday, a small town just south of Salt Lake, hoping his physical condition would permit him to make a living for them. Instead, his condition became worse and he passed away Feb. 2, 1930, at the age of 62. Even though he suffered a great deal the last years of his life, he was very patient, cheerful, and never ceased to thank the Lord for the blessings his wife and family brought to him. He was buried Feb. 5 1930 at Wasatch Lawn Cemetary, S. L. C. Will Lunt will long be remembered as a humble, spiritual man. Truly a wonderful person, and one we should be proud to have called our father.